

MARKUS KLEIN

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Role: RVP, Solution Advisory – EMEA, Coupa

PROFILE

Presales and Solutions Engineering leader with 25+ years building, scaling, and rebuilding EMEA-wide technical sales organizations at VMware, Broadcom, and Citrix. Proven track record leading second-line leaders and large distributed teams (up to 180 engineers, 20 leaders) through growth, market shifts and M&A integration, while consistently exceeding revenue targets and holding attrition below 5%. Skilled at positioning complex, multi-stakeholder platforms to senior and C-level buyers and at partnering tightly with Sales, Product and Customer Success.

CORE CAPABILITIES

- EMEA-scale Solution Advisory / Solutions Engineering leadership and team scaling
- Second-line leadership and coaching of regional leaders and managers
- Value-based selling, executive engagement, and C-level sponsorship
- Post-acquisition org rebuild and change management
- Cross-functional alignment with Sales, Product, and Customer Success
- Talent development, retention, and high-performance team culture

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Regional Executive Leader, Solutions Engineering EMEA — VMware by Broadcom

Nov 2023 – Jun 2025 | EMEA Partner & Commercial Solutions Engineering

- Rebuilt a 30+ person EMEA Solutions Engineering organization from the ground up following the Broadcom acquisition of VMware, re-establishing team structure, coverage model, and morale within months.
- Delivered 200% of target in the first year post-rebuild, restoring sales-engineering partnership and pipeline contribution across the region.
- Acted as a senior member of the EMEA Partner & Commercial leadership team, aligning Solutions Engineering strategy with regional sales goals and competitive positioning.

Senior Director, Solutions Engineering Central Europe — VMware

Sept 2014 – Oct 2023 | DACH, Eastern Europe, Russia, Israel

- Led 180 engineers and 20 second-line leaders across a multi-country region, scaling the organization through nearly a decade of product, market, and go-to-market change.
- Built and maintained a high-performance, low-attrition culture (<5%) in a highly competitive presales talent market.
- Partnered with Sales, Product Management and Customer Success leadership to align technical strategy with regional revenue targets.

Director, Systems Engineering Central Europe — Citrix

Apr 2000 – Aug 2014 | Central Europe (progressed from Systems Engineer to Director)

- Built the Central Europe presales organization from individual contributor roots into a structured regional function over 14 years.
- Developed value-based demonstration and selling methodologies adopted across the region.

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP APPROACH

I lead second-line through trusted leaders rather than managing individual contributors directly, which scales coaching impact and keeps attrition low even through organizational disruption. I treat Solutions/Solution Advisory as a partner function to Sales, Product, and Customer Success — not a downstream service — and I hold teams accountable to both revenue contribution and customer-facing technical credibility at the executive level.

LANGUAGES

German (native), English (fluent), French (learning)

REFERENCES

Torben Sebens — DeepL

Peter Goldbrunner — IGEL

Azeem Mohamed — Broadcom

John Spencer — Crowdstrike

Happy to provide more on request.